

Brand Strategy

ARC

The purpose of this deck is to bring to light the brand strategy and direction for ARC.

This deck translates ARC's positioning into a disciplined brand system covering:

- Market Tension
- Audience Reality
- Structural differentiation
- Brand Philosophy
- Brand Personality
- Messaging Architecture
- Growth Guardrails

Opportunity

In a ₹86,000 Cr category defined by stagnation, comfort clichés, and price ceilings, ARC creates India's first true luxury foundation brand.

India has:

- Mass innerwear
- Mid-premium comfort brands
- Imported logo luxury

India does not have:

- A homegrown, engineered, high-differentiation, luxury foundation brand.

ARC occupies that structural absence.

The **Role** ARC Occupies

ARC is India's first high-differentiation luxury foundation brand — created for consumers who expect the same level of precision, performance, and authority beneath their clothing as they do above it.

What The **Positioning** Resolves

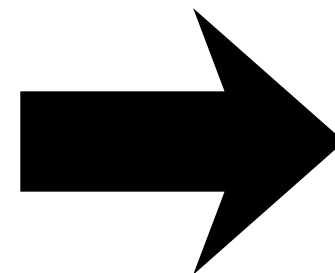
Comfort clichés

Logo tax

₹999 price ceiling

Commodity cotton

Compromised buying



Product-led authority

Earned luxury

High price, high differentiation

Engineered excellence

Standards affirmed

Who This Model Serves

Who It's For



- High-trajectory professionals - Primary: 23–35
Secondary: 35–42 (aspirational luxury upgrader)
- Design-conscious, quality-sensitive buyers
- Individuals building something — careers, companies, identity
- Proudly Indian, globally benchmarked

They want:

- Product that earns its price
- Alignment between ambition and foundation
- Confidence that holds under scrutiny
- Purchases that feel decisive, not indulgent

Who It's Not For



- Price-first shoppers
- Discount-driven buyers
- Trend-chasers
- Comfort-over-standard consumers
- Those buying logos for validation

Market & Audience Reality

Strategy must respond to **structural conditions** and **not assumptions**.

Market Reality defines the external forces shaping decisions, such as category dynamics, incentives, power structures, and risk.

Audience Reality defines the internal forces shaping behavior, like accountability, exposure and psychological pressure.

Together, they:

- Clarify the true problem being solved
- Prevent mispositioning
- Anchor differentiation in structural tension
- Ensure commercial relevance

The **External Conditions** Shaping the Category

CATEGORY STATE

- High growth (9.3% CAGR)
- Material stagnation
- Comfort-led messaging sameness
- No top-right (High Price + High Differentiation) player

COMPETITIVE INCENTIVES

- Domestic brands win via affordability
- D2C brands win via comfort positioning
- International brands win via heritage equity

CULTURAL CONTEXT

- India is:
- Younger luxury consumer base (~35)
- Rapid HNI growth
- Increasing pride in Indian brands
- Moving from logo validation → quality validation
- The shift is from visible status to earned standard.

The **Internal Forces** Driving Behavior

SURFACE JOBS

What they say they're buying:

- Buy better innerwear
- Upgrade basics
- Find premium alternative to CK

FUNCTIONAL JOBS

What the product must deliver:

- Breathable in heat
- Proper fit for Indian bodies
- 12-hour wearability
- Multi-context fluidity

PSYCHOLOGICAL JOBS

What they're actually seeking:

- Feel aligned with ambition
- Eliminate compromise
- Wear something worthy
- Remove the inferiority ceiling

Decision Psychology

BEHAVIOURAL TRUTHS

- Consumers justify visible purchases more easily than invisible ones
- Basics are treated as afterthoughts, not identity statements
- High price increases scrutiny, especially for Indian brands
- Logos reduce decision friction, even when product underperforms
- Most buyers settle because alternatives feel unclear

EMOTIONAL DRIVERS

- Fear of overpaying without real superiority
- Desire for alignment between ambition and foundation
- Frustration with comfort clichés and sameness
- Fatigue from logo-driven validation
- Need to feel that the purchase was earned — not impulsive

MARKET REALITY

India's innerwear category is high-growth but structurally stagnant — defined by cotton dominance, comfort clichés, and a ₹999 price ceiling.

International brands charge for legacy. Domestic brands cap themselves at "good enough."

No one occupies engineered luxury.

AUDIENCE REALITY

Ambitious Indians are not buying underwear. They are buying alignment between who they are and who they are becoming.

They are not looking for just comfort.
They are looking for a foundation that matches their standards.

Structural Differentiation

**Without clear distinction,
strategy defaults to similarity.
With it, the brand occupies
intentional territory.**

Understanding how the brand stands out:

- Defines the competitive battlefield
- Prevents commoditization
- Justifies premium positioning
- Anchors messaging in proof, not claims
- Creates long-term defensibility

Competitive Framing Device

01

Those Who
Sell Value

Mass Brands

02

Those Who
Sell Comfort

D2C Mid-Premium

03

Those Who
Sell Logos

International Brands

04

Those Who
Sell Standard

ARC

Unique Structural Combination

CAPABILITY	VENDORS	CONSULTANTS	ANALYSTS	ARC
Luxury price confidence	✗	✗	✓	✓
Indian-body engineering	✗	Partial	✗	✓
Climate-specific fabric strategy	✗	Partial	✗	✓
Psychological transformation positioning	✗	✗	Partial	✓
No inferiority pricing ceiling	✗	✗	✓	✓
Indian identity as authority	✗	✗	✗	✓

How ARC **Stands Out**

NO LOGO DEPENDENCE

- ARC does not borrow equity.
- The product earns the price.
- Not heritage. Not history. Not Western validation.

NO PRICE CEILING

- Indian brands capped “premium” at ₹999.
- ARC rejects that ceiling.
- Luxury pricing anchored in product.

NO COMFORT CLICHÉS

- “Second-skin comfort” is the category language.
- ARC speaks engineering, architecture, and anatomical precision.

CONSTRAINT PROTECTS AUTHORITY

- No discount-led growth.
- No trend-chasing.
- No imitation aesthetics.

Brand Belief

Without defined beliefs, strategy becomes opportunistic. With them, strategy becomes coherent and defensible. They are the decision filters.

They:

- Anchor long-term positioning
- Prevent strategic drift
- Ensure consistency across messaging, hiring, and partnerships
- Protect differentiation as the market evolves

Three Core Beliefs

01

STANDARD

Your foundation sets your standard. The layer closest to your skin is not incidental — it defines how you carry everything above it.

When the base is precise, aligned, and intentional, compromise becomes visible everywhere else. Luxury must begin where no one looks first.

02

UNCOMPROMISING

Settling is a decision — not a constraint. ARC rejects price ceilings, comfort clichés, and inherited validation.

Every fabric, proportion, and detail is chosen without dilution. The brand does not negotiate its ambition to fit the market. It builds to the level it believes should exist.

03

EARNED LUXURY

Luxury is not inherited through logos or legacy. It is constructed through material superiority, anatomical precision, and disciplined execution.

If the product does not justify its price, the brand does not deserve it. Built in India and measured against the world, ARC earns its position through engineering, not narrative.

Four Strategic Pillars

01 · SUBSTANCE OVER SURFACE

- What touches the skin matters more than what meets the eye.
- Fabric choice, proportion, and tension define the garment before visual appeal does.
- ARC builds from material truth first.

02 · FOUNDATION FIRST

- The most important layer is the one no one sees.
- ARC prioritizes the base of the wardrobe before the surface.
- Standards are built from the inside out.

03 · LONG-TERM OVER HYPE

- Trends create momentum. Standards create permanence.
- ARC avoids seasonal noise, reactive positioning, and discount-led growth.
- Every decision, from fabric sourcing to pricing, is evaluated for durability, not short-term traction.

04 · PRICE WITH CONVICTION

- Price is a signal of belief. ARC does not anchor itself to inherited ceilings or mass expectations.
- ARC refuses the inherited ₹999 ceiling that defined Indian “premium.” Price reflects build, not geography.
- Confidence in pricing reinforces confidence in identity.

The Strategy

Brand Purpose

Brand Purpose is the lofty goal that a brand commits itself to the endless pursuit of — the why behind the brand. This goal goes beyond the confines of business-minded, monetary profit

To raise the standard of what individuals believe they deserve, starting from the foundation.

Brand Vision

Brand Vision is "what" the brand does while in pursuit of its brand purpose.

To redefine the foundation layer as the most important decision in a wardrobe — establishing India's first globally respected luxury essentials brand built on uncompromising standards.

Brand Mission

Brand Mission is "the how" behind the vision of the brand. It's a tangible everyday thing the brand does that brings it closer to fulfilling its vision and purpose.

To design and deliver precision-built foundation garments through superior materials, refined proportions, and disciplined pricing, ensuring every product justifies its place, its cost, and its standard.

Brand **Boundaries**

THE BRAND IS

DELIBERATE

EXACTING

SELF-ASSURED

INTENTIONAL

THE BRAND IS NOT

MASS APPEAL

TREND REACTIVE

LOGO DEPENDENT

PRICE-LED

How ARC Behaves

Deliberate

- Nothing is added to impress. Nothing is removed to simplify.
- Every proportion, fabric choice, and word is considered.
- Restraint is not minimalism. It is intention.

Precise

- Fit is measured in millimetres.
- Tension, fall, rise, and placement matter.
- The garment must hold through movement, heat, and time.

Assured

- ARC does not seek validation.
- It does not chase consensus or soften its stance to fit expectations.
- Confidence is quiet but visible.

Bold

- It does not whisper the category. It elevates it.
- Innerwear is not hidden utility. It is charged territory.

Sensual

- Close to the skin.
- Confident in silhouette.
- Designed to be felt before it is seen.

Brand Archetypes

The category of our product, the nature of our services, and the value we add to our target user's life — all of these factors help us gauge the archetypes relevant to our brand. These archetypes influence future marketing campaigns, product innovations, communication pieces, and more from the ARC brand.

The **Two-Archetype** Model

PRIMARY

The Ruler

- Sets the standard, does not follow it.
- Commands global-level pricing without apology
- Operates with composure and control
- Defines hierarchy in stagnant categories
- Establishes India as a source of luxury authority

SECONDARY

The Lover

- Close to the skin, physically felt
- Magnetic without excess
- Sensual in proportion and silhouette
- Confidence expressed through embodiment
- Desire built through restraint

What **Audience Feel** After Engaging With ARC

01 Aligned

- What they wear matches how they live.
- No gap between ambition and foundation.
- The choice feels intentional and not convenient.

02 Certain

- The price feels justified.
- The material speaks for itself.
- There is no second-guessing after checkout.

03 Elevated

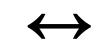
- The foundation feels considered.
- The day feels sharper.
- The standard feels non-negotiable.

04 Assured

- No second-guessing.
- No self-correction.
- The foundation carries itself.

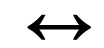
The **Balance** ARC Must Hold

Architectural



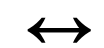
Intimate

Reserved



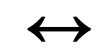
Magnetic

Precise



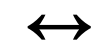
Sensual

Confident



Inviting

Controlled



Bold

Messaging Strategy

Why have a **Brand Messaging** guide?

- For a unified character across all brand touchpoints.
- To conceive a vision that steers the brand's goals to align with the brand values.
- To help define the identity of the brand by bringing the personality to the foreground.
- To inspire trust through a consistent and uniform voice that the consumer identifies with, and has confidence in.

The Strategic Tension

- The category is loud.
- Comfort is overpromised.
- Price ceilings are inherited.
- Logos distort value.
- Consumers are asked to choose between familiarity and compromise.

Messaging must acknowledge:

- Material stagnation beneath premium pricing
- Inflation of “comfort” language
- Imported validation as shortcut
- The gap between storytelling and product substance

Our communication exists to reduce that gap.

Who We Speak To

Primary Audience:

High-trajectory individuals who refuse quiet compromise.

They are:

- Quality-literate
- Detail-aware
- Design-sensitive
- Time-conscious
- Selective in what earns their money

Messaging must respect their discernment and standards.

Messaging **Mandate**

If it does not reinforce these elements, it does not align.

Every communication must:

- Make compromise feel unacceptable
- Reflect composure under scrutiny
- Demonstrate material superiority
- Signal price confidence
- No claim without substance.
- No sensuality without structure.
- No boldness without control.

Messaging **Pillars**

01

Declarative

- Lead with the standard.
- No softening language.
No hedging.
- State the position clearly
and let the product
support it.

02

Unapologetic

- No deference to
inherited ceilings.
- No apology in price.
- No justification through
comparison.
- ARC speaks from
authority, not aspiration.

03

Substantiated

- Every claim must
withstand scrutiny.
- Fabric, proportion, finish
— all verifiable.
- Desire is built on
evidence, not
exaggeration.

04

Composed

- Impact without noise.
- Bold without volume.
- Confidence expressed
through control.

Emotional Shift

Messaging should move the audience:

FROM

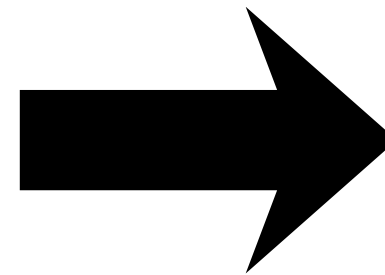
Subtle self-doubt

Private compromise

Surface-level confidence

Buying out of habit

Defaulting to imported labels



TO

Inner conviction

Aligned self-respect

Embodied confidence

Intentional ownership

Choosing Indian excellence
without hesitation

The Brand Voice Chart

What We Value	Thus, Our Voice Is	Our Communication Is	But Not
Discernment	Controlled	Evidence-anchored	Promotional
Substance	Deliberate	Composed	Over-explained
Self-respect	Magnetic	Sensory-aware	Trend-chasing

How ARC **Speaks**

✓	✗
Controlled	Hype-led
Decisive	Aspirationally insecure
Sensual	Over-familiar
Unapologetic	Over-explained

How ARC Sounds



Low-toned

Assured

Magnetic

Measured



Approval-seeking

Self-congratulatory

Didactic

Over-sensational

Messaging in Practice

HOMEPAGE

Hero:

The Foundation of Power

Sub-head:

Precision-built essentials for those who refuse compromise.

Close to the skin. Built to hold.

CTA:

Enter ARC

INSTAGRAM

Minimal. High-impact. Visual-led.

Example:

What's closest to you should be the strongest.

Cut for tension.

Built for heat.

Made to hold.

ARC – Make Settling Impossible.

Messaging in Practice

PRODUCT DESCRIPTION

ARC:

Engineered micro-modal.

Structured tension at the waist.

Cut for the Indian hip line.

12-hour hold without drift.

Not ARC:

Ultra-soft cotton blend with superior comfort.

Designed for all-day wear. Upgrade to premium comfort essentials.

RESPONSE TO NEGATIVE REVIEW

Review:

“Too expensive for innerwear.”

Weak Response:

We’re sorry you feel that way! Our pricing reflects quality materials and craftsmanship.

ARC Response:

Price reflects material, structure, and durability. If those do not matter to you, we may not be the right brand.

Messaging in Practice

LAUNCH EMAIL

Subject:

Built Here. Without Ceiling.

Body:

India has built companies, talent, and global influence.

It has not built a luxury foundation brand measured against the world.

Until now.

ARC launches with one principle:

What sits closest to you should meet your highest standard.

Enter ARC.

CART ABANDONMENT

Text:

Still Considering?

If price is the hesitation, consider what it replaces.

Material that holds.

Fit that stays.

Structure that lasts.

We do not discount construction.

Complete your order.

The Big Idea

The Big Idea

The unifying statement that affects all the other ideas of the brand, both internal as well as external.

Business Ideas

Internal

Culture product +
Services Design +
Experience Sustainability

Big Idea

Marketing Ideas

External

Actions PR Content Advertising

- Foster efficiency in decision-making
- Help lead organisational decisions beyond marketing
- Create a guiding light for collaboration/innovation

- Spark ideas across the spectrum
- Assure consistency over a long timeline
- Catalyse consistent brand experience

THE BIG IDEA

Unseen. Unmatched.



ARC lives at the foundation: the layer no one notices, yet everything depends on. It is close to the skin, felt before it is seen. The most important decisions in a wardrobe are often invisible, but they shape posture, movement, and presence.



Built in India and held to global scrutiny, ARC competes on material, proportion, and discipline and not logo or legacy. It does not borrow hierarchy. It earns it, setting a benchmark the category has yet to meet.

THE STRATEGIC EXPRESSION

This is the principle that explains and governs the Big Idea, ensuring it is not just said, but consistently built and upheld across the brand. Think of it like a strategic extension.

Under It All. Above Compromise.



ARC begins at the foundation — the layer closest to the body and the first point of contact with the day. What sits beneath everything should be constructed with intention, precision, and strength. The base is not incidental. It determines how everything above it carries.



ARC refuses inherited ceilings, diluted materials, or price anchored in apology. Built in India and measured globally, it operates without concession — holding form, holding standard, and rejecting anything that falls short.

HOW THEY WORK TOGETHER

UNSEEN. UNMATCHED.

This is the Big Idea — the brand's clearest and most distilled articulation. It captures ARC's position in the category: a foundation layer that is invisible in placement, yet unmatched in construction and standard. It is bold, campaign-ready, and public-facing.

UNDER IT ALL. ABOVE COMPROMISE.

This operates as the campaign-level expression beneath it — expanding the idea with philosophy. It explains why ARC is unmatched: because what sits at the base is built without concession.

Everything **Ladders Up**

IN PRODUCT

Material before marketing.

IN CONTENT

Substance over spectacle.

IN DESIGN

Restraint over excess.

IN GROWTH

Standard before scale.